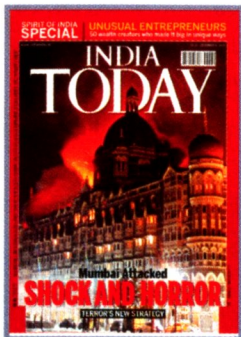


Mumbai Attacked: Shock and Horror

DECEMBER 8, 2008

The scourge of terror revisits India's cosmopolitan heart as deadly and coordinated attacks leave a trail of blood and misery. Who planned the terror strategy? What are the consequences? What should India's response be?



“ We need to ask our politicians what they are doing to ensure our safety and security. And they would most probably have no answer for their incompetence to handle such situations. ”

NIRUPAMA LAROA, *via www.indiatoday.in*

Terror Trauma

While exposing the impotence of our internal security and governance, the 26/11 Mumbai terror attacks have revealed the courage of the police force, army and the media which carried out their responsibilities relentlessly. All that the Government seems to be doing after every such attack is to condemn, criticise and announce compensation. Forums and cells created to combat terrorism work on cracking past cases, and these organisations do little or nothing to prevent such events. It remains to be seen if Mumbai attacks jolt the Government to act sternly and keep terrorism at bay.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR,

Bangalore,

via www.indiatoday.in



PANKAJ TIWARI

Early Signs

While Congress's Kamal Nath preferred to cash in on his 'hard-earned' frequent flier miles jetting between Delhi and Chhindwara to woo voters in Madhya Pradesh, BJP's Shivraj Singh Chouhan paced the length and the breadth of the state on foot instead ("The Lotus and the Kamal", November 24). A stark contrast in their approach proves who is better connected with the people. It also tells a lot about who will fly high and who will bite the dust in the polls.

MANOJ KUMAR, Shimla, *via www.indiatoday.in*

The elephant's march to 7, Race Course Road has begun with a giant stride ("Jumbo's Circus", December 1). All that remains to be seen is how far Maya's magic succeeds in grabbing the vote share of other parties.

SHYAM SINGH, *via www.indiatoday.in*

The impunity with which the terrorists struck Mumbai speaks volumes about our lax surveillance along the borders and coast, ineffective intelligence gathering, improper policing and, above all, lack of a cohesive policy to combat such terror activities.

ARCHANA NEGI,

via www.indiatoday.in

The fidayeen attack heralds the beginning of a new phase of jihadi violence, far more devastating in terms of spreading panic and fear, apart from making the state look miserably impotent. The failure of the Government, however, must not weaken the nation's resolve to stand united against the evil forces of terrorism.

J. AKSHOBHIYA, Mysore,

via www.indiatoday.in

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE CALL: (95120) 2479900 from DELHI and FARIDABAD: (0120) 2479900 from REST OF INDIA: Fax (0120) 4078080
KOLKATA: Tel 22821922, 22827726, 22825398 Fax 22825398, 22827254 BANGALORE: Tel 2212448, 2290562, 2218343 Fax 2218335 MUMBAI: Tel 24444423/4/5/6
Fax 24444358 CHENNAI: Tel 28478525-44 Fax 28472178. FOR CUSTOMER CARE CALL: 1800 1800 100 (from BSNL/MTNL lines) 120 2479900 (Monday-Friday: 10am-6 pm):
WRITE IN: WE CARE, The India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (U.P.)-201301. e-mail: wecare@intoday.com